OneRhythm

Brand Guidelines

A Futuristic Design System for Community and Solidarity

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Brand Philosophy

Design Vision

OneRhythm occupies a rare intersection: deeply personal health experience meets futuristic technology infrastructure. The visual identity must honor both dimensions. The design language draws from the aesthetics of advanced data visualization, deep-space imagery, and biomedical monitoring—but always in service of a fundamentally human mission: reducing isolation and building solidarity among arrhythmia patients.

> *Design principle: Every visual decision should feel like looking at a heartbeat monitor on the bridge of a spacecraft—precise, luminous, alive—while never forgetting that the rhythm on that screen belongs to a real person.*

The Aesthetic Direction

The OneRhythm aesthetic is best described as “bioluminescent futurism.” It merges the organic pulse of living systems with the clean precision of advanced technology. The visual language borrows from deep-sea bioluminescence, cardiac monitoring displays, and generative data art—creating an atmosphere that is simultaneously clinical and warm, futuristic and deeply human.

Core tensions the design must hold: Technical precision paired with emotional warmth. Dark, immersive environments that feel inviting rather than cold. Futuristic interfaces that remain accessible to non-technical users. Luminous visual effects grounded in purposeful information design.

Emotional Keywords

- Luminous — light emerging from darkness, signals of life
- Connected — individual rhythms joined into collective meaning
- Resilient — strength through shared experience, not isolation
- Precise — clean, trustworthy, technically sophisticated
- Alive — pulsing, breathing, never static

Color System

Design Rationale

The color system is built on a dark-first foundation. Dark interfaces reduce eye strain for users who may spend extended time reading educational content, evoke the aesthetic of biomedical

monitoring displays, and allow luminous accent colors to carry maximum emotional impact. The palette is organized into three tiers: environment (backgrounds), signal (primary actions and accents), and information (semantic states).

Environment Colors (Backgrounds & Surfaces)

These form the spatial depth of the interface. Layered dark tones create a sense of dimensionality without relying on drop shadows or borders.

	Name	Hex	Usage
	Deep Void	`#0A0E1A`	Primary background, page canvas, immersive base layer
	Midnight	`#111827`	Secondary background, sidebar, navigation containers
	Cosmos	`#1A1F35`	Card surfaces, modal backgrounds, elevated content panels
	Nebula	`#252B48`	Hover states, interactive surface elevation, active selection

Signal Colors (Primary Accents)

Signal colors carry meaning and draw attention. They are used sparingly and intentionally—never as backgrounds, always as focal points.

	Name	Hex	Usage
	Pulse Red	`#FF2D55`	Primary CTA, heartbeat motif, mosaic accent, brand signature
	Pulse Glow	`#FF6B8A`	Hover/focus glow on Pulse Red elements, soft heartbeat aura
	Pulse Dark	`#CC1A3D`	Active/pressed state for Pulse Red, high-contrast text on light bg
	Signal Cyan	`#00D4FF`	Secondary accent, data visualization, links, progress indicators
	Signal Soft	`#66E5FF`	Highlighted text, focus rings, tooltip backgrounds
	Signal Dim	`#0099CC`	Muted data points, inactive secondary elements
	Aurora Violet	`#7C3AED`	Tertiary accent, blockchain/transparency features, decorative gradients

	Aurora Glow	#A78BFA	Lighter tertiary, mosaic tile highlights, achievement badges

Text & UI Colors

	Name	Hex	Usage
	Primary Text	#F9FAFB	Headings, body text, high-emphasis content on dark backgrounds
	Secondary Text	#9CA3AF	Captions, labels, supporting copy, timestamps
	Tertiary Text	#6B7280	Placeholder text, disabled states, very low emphasis
	Border	#374151	Dividers, input borders, card outlines, separators
	Success	#10B981	Upload complete, consent recorded, positive confirmation
	Warning	#F59E0B	Consent required, incomplete profile, attention needed

Gradient Definitions

Gradients are used to evoke depth, energy, and the organic movement of bioluminescent systems. They should always feel like light emerging from the environment, never flat or decorative.

Name	Definition	Usage
Heartbeat Gradient	linear-gradient(135deg, #FF2D55, #CC1A3D, #7C3AED)	Hero sections, CTA buttons, mosaic overlay pulse animation
Signal Gradient	linear-gradient(135deg, #00D4FF, #7C3AED)	Data visualization accents, progress bars, educational content headers
Void Gradient	radial-gradient(ellipse at center, #1A1F35, #0A0E1A)	Full-page backgrounds, immersive mosaic viewing mode
Aurora Gradient	linear-gradient(180deg, #7C3AED, #00D4FF, #FF2D55)	Mosaic heart silhouette glow, contribution celebration animation

Color Accessibility Rules

- All text must meet WCAG 2.1 AA contrast ratios: 4.5:1 minimum for body text, 3:1 for large text (18px+ bold or 24px+ regular).

- Primary Text (#F9FAFB) on Deep Void (#0A0E1A) achieves a contrast ratio of approximately 18.1:1 — far exceeding requirements.
- Pulse Red (#FF2D55) on Deep Void (#0A0E1A) achieves approximately 4.6:1 — suitable for large text and interactive elements only. Use Pulse Dark (#CC1A3D) for small text on light backgrounds.
- Signal Cyan (#00D4FF) on Deep Void (#0A0E1A) achieves approximately 8.9:1 — safe for all text sizes.
- Never place Pulse Red text on Signal Cyan backgrounds (or vice versa). These accent colors are not designed for direct combination in text contexts.
- A dedicated high-contrast mode must swap to a light background with dark text, maintaining the accent color hierarchy.

Typography

Type System Overview

The typographic system pairs a distinctive display face with a highly readable body face. The goal is to feel futuristic at first glance and effortlessly readable on sustained engagement—critical for a platform where users read educational health content at length.

Font Selection

Role	Font	Source	Rationale
Display / Headlines	Exo 2	Google Fonts (free)	Geometric sans-serif with a technological, futuristic character. 18 weights from Thin to Black + italics. Feels innovative without sacrificing legibility.
Body / UI	DM Sans	Google Fonts (free)	Clean, geometric sans-serif commissioned by DeepMind. Exceptional screen readability with generous x-height. Variable font support for precise weight control.
Monospace / Data	Space Mono	Google Fonts (free)	Retro-futuristic monospace by Colophon Foundry. Used for hash displays, contribution IDs, blockchain references, and code-like UI elements.

Type Scale

The type scale follows a 1.25 (Major Third) ratio, creating a clear visual hierarchy that works across screen sizes. All sizes reference rem units based on a 16px root.

Element	Size	Weight	Font	Usage
Display XL	3.052rem (49px)	700	Exo 2	Hero headline, mosaic counter
Display	2.441rem (39px)	700	Exo 2	Page titles, section headers
H1	1.953rem (31px)	600	Exo 2	Primary content headings
H2	1.563rem (25px)	600	Exo 2	Sub-section headings
H3	1.25rem (20px)	600	DM Sans	Card titles, form section labels
Body	1rem (16px)	400	DM Sans	All body text, educational content
Body Small	0.875rem (14px)	400	DM Sans	Captions, metadata, disclaimers
Caption	0.75rem (12px)	500	DM Sans	Labels, timestamps, tile metadata
Mono	0.875rem (14px)	400	Space Mono	Hash values, contribution IDs, blockchain data

Typography Rules

- Line height: 1.5 for body text, 1.2 for headings, 1.7 for long-form educational content.
- Maximum line length: 72 characters for educational content. Readability degrades significantly beyond this threshold.
- Letter spacing: +0.02em on all-caps labels (buttons, badges, metadata tags). -0.01em on Display XL for visual tightening at large sizes.
- Never use Exo 2 below 18px. It is a display face—forcing it into small sizes undermines legibility.
- Never use more than two type weights on a single screen (e.g., 400 + 600, or 400 + 700). Over-variation creates visual noise.
- The medical disclaimer must always render in DM Sans at Body Small size (14px) minimum. Never reduce disclaimer text below this threshold.

Logo & Wordmark

Wordmark

The OneRhythm wordmark uses Exo 2 Bold with custom letter spacing of +0.05em. The word “One” is set in the Primary Text color (#F9FAFB on dark backgrounds) while “Rhythm” uses Pulse Red (#FF2D55), creating a visual emphasis on the unifying concept of rhythm.

> *On dark backgrounds: “One” in #F9FAFB + “Rhythm” in #FF2D55. On light backgrounds: “One” in #0A0E1A + “Rhythm” in #CC1A3D (Pulse Dark for contrast).*

Icon Mark

The icon mark is a minimalist heart silhouette constructed from a continuous ECG waveform line. The line enters from the left as a flat baseline, pulses upward into a stylized QRS complex that traces the upper-left curve of the heart, continues through the right side, and resolves back to a baseline at the exit point. The entire form is rendered as a single, unbroken stroke—symbolizing the continuous, shared rhythm that connects the community.

Construction: The icon must work at 16px (favicon), 32px (tab icon), 64px (app icon), and 512px (splash/marketing). At small sizes, the waveform detail simplifies to preserve clarity—the heart silhouette dominates. At large sizes, the full waveform detail is visible.

Color: The icon mark uses the Heartbeat Gradient (Pulse Red → Pulse Dark → Aurora Violet) in full-color applications. A monochrome white version is used on dark backgrounds where gradient rendering is limited.

Clear Space & Sizing

- Minimum clear space around the wordmark: equal to the cap-height of the “O” in “One.”
- Minimum clear space around the icon mark: equal to 25% of the icon’s width on all sides.
- Minimum wordmark size: 120px wide for digital, 30mm for print.
- Minimum icon mark size: 16px × 16px.

Logo Misuse

- Never rotate the logo or icon mark.
- Never stretch, compress, or distort proportions.
- Never place the logo on a background that fails to meet contrast requirements.

- Never add effects (drop shadows, outer glow, bevel) to the logo.
- Never use unapproved colors. Only the defined palette is permitted.
- Never typeset the wordmark in a font other than Exo 2 Bold.

Visual Language & UI Patterns

Surface & Depth

The interface creates depth through layered dark surfaces rather than traditional shadows or borders. Each surface level uses a progressively lighter shade from the Environment palette, evoking the feeling of objects emerging from deep space toward the viewer.

Level	Color	Usage
Level 0 (Canvas)	Deep Void (#0A0E1A)	Page background, full-bleed sections, mosaic viewing canvas
Level 1 (Container)	Midnight (#111827)	Navigation bars, sidebars, section containers
Level 2 (Card)	Cosmos (#1A1F35)	Content cards, modal panels, form containers, educational content blocks
Level 3 (Elevated)	Nebula (#252B48)	Hover states, active selections, tooltip containers, dropdown menus

Border Radius

A consistent border-radius system conveys the blend of precision and organic warmth. Larger elements use more rounding; smaller elements stay crisp.

Token	Value	Usage
radius-sm	4px	Input fields, inline tags, small badges
radius-md	8px	Buttons, cards, dropdowns, tooltips
radius-lg	12px	Modals, large containers, image frames
radius-xl	16px	Hero sections, feature cards, mosaic embed frame
radius-full	9999px	Avatar circles, pill badges, toggle switches

Glow & Luminance Effects

Glow effects are central to the bioluminescent aesthetic. They simulate light emission from interactive elements, creating the feeling that the interface itself is alive. Use them sparingly and purposefully—every glow must communicate state or importance.

Effect	CSS Definition	Usage
Pulse Glow	box-shadow: 0 0 20px rgba(255,45,85,0.3)	Primary CTA buttons on hover, heartbeat animation keyframes
Signal Glow	box-shadow: 0 0 16px rgba(0,212,255,0.25)	Focus rings on inputs, active data visualizations
Aurora Glow	box-shadow: 0 0 24px rgba(124,58,237,0.2)	Achievement moments, consent-confirmed feedback, mosaic tile placement
Subtle Glow	box-shadow: 0 0 8px rgba(255,255,255,0.05)	Card hover elevation, navigation active state

Motion & Animation

Motion should feel organic and heartbeat-inspired—never mechanical or robotic. The primary animation metaphor is the cardiac rhythm: a steady, reliable pulse punctuated by moments of heightened activity.

Principle	Timing	Application
Heartbeat Pulse	1.2s ease-in-out, infinite	Mosaic heart outline subtle pulse, loading state, contribution counter
Entry Reveal	400ms cubic-bezier(0.16,1,0.3,1)	Card entrance, content fade-in, page transitions
Micro-interaction	150ms ease-out	Button press, toggle switch, hover state transitions
Celebration	800ms spring(1,80,10)	Tile placement confirmation, consent recorded, milestone reached
Data Transition	300ms ease-in-out	Chart updates, mosaic zoom, tile info panel slide

- The mosaic heart silhouette should have a continuous, subtle pulse animation (scale 1.0 → 1.005 → 1.0) at a rate of approximately 72 BPM—resting human heart rate. This creates an ambient sense of life.

- When a new tile is placed, a ripple animation originates from the tile's position and radiates outward through the mosaic, briefly illuminating neighboring tiles. This visualizes the idea that each contribution strengthens the whole.
- Page transitions should use a vertical wipe with a subtle red glow leading edge, evoking the sweep of an ECG trace across a monitor.
- Prefer CSS animations over JavaScript animation libraries where possible for performance. Use the Motion (Framer Motion) library for React component orchestration.
- Always respect the prefers-reduced-motion media query. When active, disable all ambient animations and reduce transitions to instant or near-instant state changes.

Iconography

Icons use a 24px grid with 1.5px stroke weight by default. The icon style is outlined (not filled), consistent with the "light tracing through darkness" aesthetic. Icons should feel like luminous line drawings on a dark canvas.

- Use Lucide React as the primary icon library. It provides consistent, well-crafted outlined icons that align with the stroke-based aesthetic.
- Icon color defaults to Secondary Text (#9CA3AF). Active/selected icons use Signal Cyan (#00D4FF) or Pulse Red (#FF2D55) depending on context.
- Custom icons (heart-ECG hybrid mark, mosaic tiles, blockchain hash) must follow the same 24px grid and 1.5px stroke weight for visual consistency.
- Never use filled icons unless explicitly indicating an active/toggled state (e.g., a filled heart for "contributed" vs. an outlined heart for "not yet contributed").

The Heart Mosaic: Visual Design

Tile Design Language

Each mosaic tile is a visual fingerprint of an anonymized ECG waveform. The tile's visual properties are derived from the waveform's characteristics, creating unique visual identities within a unified system.

Waveform Property	Visual Mapping	Range
Heart rate (density)	Tile color temperature (cool → warm)	Signal Cyan → Pulse Red across the spectrum
QRS amplitude	Tile brightness/luminosity	20% opacity (low) → 100% opacity (high)

Rhythm regularity	Tile texture (smooth → textured)	Flat fill → fine noise pattern overlay
Waveform complexity	Tile border glow intensity	No glow → visible Aurora Glow aura

Heart Silhouette Composition

- The heart silhouette fills from center outward using a spiral-growth algorithm, so the earliest contributions form the emotional core.
- The outline of the heart is defined by a parametric curve, not a static image—allowing it to scale infinitely as contributions grow.
- A faint outline of the complete heart is visible from the start, rendered in Border color (#374151) at 30% opacity, giving users a sense of the eventual form even before the mosaic is full.
- When the mosaic is viewed at a distance (zoomed out), the collective color mixing of individual tiles creates an organic, gradient-like appearance across the heart—an emergent visual property, not a designed one.
- The background behind the heart should use the Void Gradient (radial, center-origin) to create the impression of the heart floating in deep space.

Interaction States

- Default: Tiles render at their derived visual properties. No glow. Static.
- Hover: Tile elevates slightly (scale 1.05), subtle glow appears (color matched to tile's base hue), and an info tooltip fades in showing contribution date and condition category.
- Selected: Tile border illuminates in Signal Cyan, info panel slides in from the right with extended metadata.
- User's own tile: A faint, persistent Pulse Glow aura distinguishes the user's contribution from others, but only when the user is logged in.

Component Design Patterns

Buttons

Variant	Style	Usage
Primary	Filled Pulse Red background, white text, radius-md, Pulse Glow on hover	Upload ECG, Submit Profile, Primary CTA

Secondary	Outlined with Signal Cyan border, Signal Cyan text, transparent fill, Signal Glow on hover	View Mosaic, Learn More, Secondary actions
Ghost	No border, Secondary Text color, Nebula background on hover	Navigation links, tertiary actions, filter toggles
Danger	Outlined with Warning border, Warning text, warning glow on hover	Delete data, revoke consent, destructive actions

Cards

Cards use the Cosmos (#1A1F35) surface color with a 1px Border (#374151) outline and radius-lg (12px). On hover, cards transition to Nebula (#252B48) with a Subtle Glow effect. Content cards for educational material include a colored top-border accent (2px) using the condition-category color from the mosaic palette.

Forms & Inputs

- Input fields: Midnight (#111827) background, Border (#374151) stroke, radius-sm (4px). Focus state adds Signal Glow ring.
- Labels: DM Sans, Caption size (12px), Secondary Text color (#9CA3AF), uppercase with +0.05em letter spacing.
- Validation errors: Pulse Red text below the input, field border transitions to Pulse Red.
- Consent checkboxes: Custom styled with Pulse Red fill when checked and a subtle scale animation on toggle.

The Medical Disclaimer Component

This is the most important recurring UI element in the application. It must appear on every screen that displays educational content, and it must be persistent, visible, and non-dismissible.

- Background: Cosmos (#1A1F35) with a 2px left border in Warning (#F59E0B).
- Text: DM Sans, Body Small (14px), Secondary Text color (#9CA3AF).
- An info icon (Lucide: AlertCircle) in Warning color precedes the disclaimer text.
- The component must not include a close or dismiss button. It is always visible.
- In high-contrast mode, the disclaimer uses a yellow background with dark text for maximum visibility.

Photography & Imagery

Photography Style

When photography is used (marketing materials, social media, about pages), it should feel intimate, authentic, and warm—a deliberate counterpoint to the futuristic UI. OneRhythm is built for real people experiencing real conditions. Photography grounds the technology in humanity.

- Subjects should be photographed in natural settings (homes, parks, everyday life)—never in clinical environments.
- Warm, natural lighting is preferred. Avoid harsh studio lighting or overly processed color grading.
- Diverse representation is mandatory. ARVC and arrhythmias affect people of all ages, ethnicities, and backgrounds. Photography must reflect this.
- Never depict people as visibly ill, distressed, or in medical crisis. Subjects should appear active, engaged, and living full lives.
- A subtle dark vignette can be applied to photography to help it blend with the dark UI aesthetic when used within the application.

Illustration & Generative Art

Abstract generative art—derived from the same waveform-to-visual mapping used in the mosaic tiles—can serve as decorative elements throughout the platform. These are not diagnostic visualizations; they are artistic interpretations that reinforce the brand's identity.

- Generative art should use the brand color palette exclusively.
- Organic, flowing forms are preferred over rigid geometric grids. Think bioluminescent organisms, not circuit boards.
- Generative patterns can be used as background textures, section dividers, loading states, and social media assets.
- Never label generative art as "ECG analysis" or "heart scan." It is art, not data. This distinction is regulatory-critical.

Voice & Tone

Brand Voice

OneRhythm speaks as a knowledgeable companion—never a doctor, never a patient, but someone who understands both perspectives. The voice is warm without being saccharine, technical without being alienating, and empowering without being dismissive of the real struggles patients face.

We Sound Like	We Never Sound Like
"Here's what we found about your condition."	"Your ECG shows signs of..."
"Questions you might want to bring to your doctor."	"We recommend the following treatment."
"Your rhythm has joined 4,327 others."	"Thank you for your data submission."
"You're not alone in this."	"Join our patient database."
"Recent research that may be relevant to you."	"New cure discovered for your condition."

Tone by Context

Context	Tone	Example
Onboarding	Warm, inviting, simple	"Welcome to OneRhythm. Let's start by getting to know your experience."
ECG Upload	Reassuring, clear, direct	"Your image is being processed. All identifying information is being removed."
Educational Content	Informative, measured, empowering	"Atrial fibrillation is the most common sustained cardiac arrhythmia..."
Mosaic Interaction	Poetic, emotional, communal	"4,327 heartbeats. One rhythm."
Error States	Honest, calm, solution-oriented	"We couldn't process this image. It may help to try a higher-resolution photo."
Consent Flow	Clear, transparent, respectful	"Before we continue, here's exactly what happens with your data."

Responsive Design & Accessibility

Breakpoints

Breakpoint	Width	Layout
Mobile	≤ 639px	Single column, stacked cards, simplified mosaic view (2D grid instead of WebGL)
Tablet	640px – 1023px	Two-column layout, condensed sidebar, WebGL mosaic with touch controls

Desktop	1024px – 1279px	Full layout, sidebar navigation, full WebGL mosaic with hover interactions
Wide	≥ 1280px	Content max-width constrained, generous whitespace, immersive mosaic mode available

Accessibility Requirements

- WCAG 2.1 AA compliance is the minimum standard. Target AAA where feasible, especially for educational content.
- All interactive elements must be keyboard navigable with visible focus indicators (Signal Glow ring).
- The mosaic must include a screen reader-accessible alternative: an aria-live region that announces new contributions and a text-based summary of mosaic statistics.
- High contrast mode switches from the dark palette to a light background (#F9FAFB) with dark text (#0A0E1A), maintaining accent color usage for interactive elements.
- All images, including mosaic tile previews and generative art, must include descriptive alt text.
- Form validation errors must be announced via aria-live regions, not communicated through color alone.
- Touch targets must be a minimum of 44px × 44px on mobile devices.
- The medical disclaimer must be marked as an aria-live polite region so it is announced by screen readers on every page that includes educational content.

Implementation Reference: CSS Variables

The following CSS custom properties define the complete brand system for implementation in the Next.js frontend. They should be defined in the global stylesheet and referenced throughout all components.

> *File: apps/web/src/app/globals.css*

```
:root {
  /* Environment */
  --color-deep-void: #0A0E1A;
  --color-midnight: #111827;
  --color-cosmos: #1A1F35;
  --color-nebula: #252B48;

  /* Signal — Primary */
  --color-pulse: #FF2D55;
```

```
  --color-pulse-glow: #FF6B8A;
  --color-pulse-dark: #CC1A3D;

  /* Signal — Secondary */
  --color-signal: #00D4FF;
  --color-signal-soft: #66E5FF;
  --color-signal-dim: #0099CC;

  /* Signal — Tertiary */
  --color-aurora: #7C3AED;
  --color-aurora-glow: #A78BFA;

  /* Text */
  --color-text-primary: #F9FAFB;
  --color-text-secondary: #9CA3AF;
  --color-text-tertiary: #6B7280;

  /* UI */
  --color-border: #374151;
  --color-success: #10B981;
  --color-warning: #F59E0B;

  /* Typography */
  --font-display: 'Exo 2', sans-serif;
  --font-body: 'DM Sans', sans-serif;
  --font-mono: 'Space Mono', monospace;

  /* Radii */
  --radius-sm: 4px;
  --radius-md: 8px;
  --radius-lg: 12px;
  --radius-xl: 16px;
  --radius-full: 9999px;

  /* Transitions */
  --ease-heartbeat: cubic-bezier(0.4, 0, 0.2, 1);
  --ease-reveal: cubic-bezier(0.16, 1, 0.3, 1);
  --duration-micro: 150ms;
  --duration-normal: 300ms;
  --duration-reveal: 400ms;
}
```

Implementation Reference: Tailwind Configuration

Extend the default Tailwind configuration to include all brand tokens. This ensures the design system is available as utility classes throughout the application.

> *File: apps/web/tailwind.config.ts*

```
colors: {
```

```
  void: { DEFAULT: '#0A0E1A', midnight: '#111827' },
  cosmos: { DEFAULT: '#1A1F35', nebula: '#252B48' },
  pulse: { DEFAULT: '#FF2D55', glow: '#FF6B8A', dark: '#CC1A3D' },
  signal: { DEFAULT: '#00D4FF', soft: '#66E5FF', dim: '#0099CC' },
  aurora: { DEFAULT: '#7C3AED', glow: '#A78BFA' },
}
fontFamily: {
  display: ['Exo 2', 'sans-serif'],
  body: ['DM Sans', 'sans-serif'],
  mono: ['Space Mono', 'monospace'],
}
```

End of document.